

Computer Science & IT

Database Management System



Relational Model & Normal Forms

Lecture No. 03



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Recap of Previous Lecture



✓
Topic

Relational Database Model

✓
Topic

Functional dependency

✓
Topic

Types of functional dependency

Topics to be Covered



✓ Topic

Properties of functional dependency

✓ Topic

Different types of keys in RDBMS

Topic

Candidate key

Topic

Super key



Topic : Functional dependency (FD)

Functional dependencies are used to specify the relationship among the attributes of a given relation.

Functional dependencies are denoted using the format

$$X \longrightarrow Y$$

Where X & Y are some set of attributes from the given relation

If $X \longrightarrow Y$ exist in relation R

then "X" is called determinant attribute set

& "Y" is called dependent attribute set



Topic : Functional dependency (FD)

- ☐ Functional dependency defines the relationship between two sets of attributes in a relational table.
- ☐ It states that the values of dependent attribute set can be completely determined by the values of determinant attributes set. In other words, if a determinant attribute's value is known, the value of the dependent attribute can be deduced.



Topic : Functional dependency (FD)

- Let R be the relational schema with X and Y as the attribute sets over relation R .

Functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exists in R only if
For all pair of tuples $t_1, t_2 \in R$
If $t_1.X = t_2.X$ then $t_1.Y = t_2.Y$

IF functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exists in R
then (for all pair of tuples $t_1, t_2 \in R$
if $t_1.X = t_2.X$ then $t_1.Y = t_2.Y$)

P only if $Q \equiv$ if P then Q

P	Q	$(P \rightarrow Q)$
True	True	True

If $P \rightarrow Q$ is true
then is it necessary for $Q \rightarrow P$ to be true

Ans is NO.

∴ If, for all pair of tuples $t_1, t_2 \in R$
(if $t_1.X = t_2.X$ then $t_1.Y = t_2.Y$)

then functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exists in R

Need not be true



Topic : Functional dependency (FD)

- If functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exists in the relation
then,

Whenever values w.r.t. attribute set X are
same in any pair of tuples, then in those
tuples values of Y will also be same

it is the necessary condⁿ
for $X \rightarrow Y$ to exist in a
relation, but not sufficient

But if values of " Y " are same in
two tuples, then values of X need not
be same in those tuples

→ Consider the following relation: -

Sid	Sname	Branch
1	Ram	CS
2	Ram	CS
3	John	IT
4	Mohan	CS
5	Sai	IT

Student
Relation

If we know value of "Sid" then we can uniquely identify the "Sname" w.r.t. that "Sid"

∴ Functional dependency

$Sid \rightarrow Sname$

may exist in the relation

Necessary Condⁿ
holds true in this
relation w.r.t. FD

$Sid \rightarrow Sname$
x y

∴ $Sid \rightarrow Sname$
may hold in the
relation

→ Consider the following relation: -

Sid	Sname	Branch
1	Ram	CS
2	Ram	CS
3	John	IT
4	Mohan	CS
5	Sai	IT
Student Relation		
6	Ram	IT

In this specific relational instance, If we know the "Sname" then we can uniquely identify "Branch" w.r.t given Sname

∴ Sname → Branch may hold true

Necessary Condⁿ holds true in this relation w.r.t. FD

Sname → Branch

∴ Sname → Branch may hold in the relation

→ Consider the following relation: -

Sid	Sname	Branch
1	Ram	CS
2	Ram	CS
3	John	IT
4	Mohan	CS
5	Sai	IT

Student
Relation

In this specific relational instance, If we know the "Branch" of the student then we may not uniquely identify the "Sname" w.r.t. given "Branch".

∴ $\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$ does not hold (exists) in the given relation

Necessary Condⁿ does not hold true in this relation w.r.t. FD

$\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$

∴ FD, $\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$ can never exist in this relation



Topic : Functional dependency (FD)

- ❑ If necessary condition for functional dependency " $X \rightarrow Y$ " does not hold true based on given relation instance, then functional dependency " $X \rightarrow Y$ " can never exist in the given relation.
- ❑ Even if necessary condition for functional dependency " $X \rightarrow Y$ " does hold true based on given relation instance, then also we can not be sure whether functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exists in the relation or not, because it is just the relational instance. ✓

#Q. Consider the following relational instance

	A	B	C
t_1	1	2	3
t_2	1	2	4
	2	2	1
	3	1	2
	4	1	2

Handwritten annotations on the table: Blue circles around (1,2,3) and (1,2,4). Yellow circles around (2,2,1), (3,1,2), and (4,1,2). A green arrow points from the first row to $A \not\rightarrow C$. A yellow arrow points from the last row to $BC \not\rightarrow A$. A pink checkmark is next to $A \rightarrow B$.

$$A \not\rightarrow C$$

$$A \rightarrow B$$

$$AB \not\rightarrow C$$

$$BC \not\rightarrow A$$

Which of the following functional dependency **may hold true (not necessarily)** based on given relational instance.

a) $A \rightarrow C$

☒ b) $A \rightarrow B$

c) $AB \rightarrow C$

d) $BC \rightarrow A$

#Q.

Consider the following relational instance

A	B	C
1	1	1
1	2	2
2	4	3
3	3	4
4	1	5
5	3	6

No two values of 'C' are same
or we don't need to worry about other

Which of the following functional dependency **may hold true (not necessarily)** based on given relational instance.

~~a) $B \rightarrow C$~~

~~b) $A \rightarrow B$~~

~~c) $C \rightarrow B$~~

~~d) $B \rightarrow A$~~

~~e) $C \rightarrow A$~~

#Q. From the following instance of a relation schema $R(A,B,C)$, we can conclude that:

A	B	C
1	1	1
1	1	0
2	3	2
2	3	2

we can conclude, that

$B \rightarrow C$ can never hold in this relation

Necessary
Condⁿ is true
w.r.t.

$A \rightarrow B$

i.e. $A \rightarrow B$ may
hold, but we

Can not conclude that
 $A \rightarrow B$ holds in the relation

(A) ~~A functionally determines B, and B functionally determines C~~

(B) ~~A functionally determines B, and B does not functionally determine C~~

(C) B does not functionally determine C

(D) ~~A does not functionally determine B, and B does not functionally determine C~~

Note: Functional dependencies that holds true in a relation are identified by database designer, and mostly they are given in the question



Topic : Types of Functional Dependency

* There are two types of functional dependencies

- ① Trivial functional dependency
- ② Non-trivial functional dependency

We can define a third type of functional dependency
Which is actually a mixture of trivial & non-trivial.
∴ We can call it "Semi-non-trivial functional dependency."



Topic : Trivial Functional Dependency

If X and Y are two sets of attributes over relation R such that $X \supseteq Y$,
then $X \rightarrow Y$ is called a trivial FD.

Every trivial FD possible
from the attributes of a relation
will always hold true in that relation
but they will not provide
any useful information

eg: $Sid, Sname \rightarrow Sid$

$Sid, Sname \rightarrow Sname$

$Sid, Sname \rightarrow Sid, Sname$



Topic : Non-trivial Functional Dependency

FD $X \rightarrow Y$ is called a non-trivial FD in relation R

Only if, (i) X and Y are non-empty set of attributes over relation R

and (ii) $X \cap Y = \emptyset$

Eg. $R(\text{Sid}, \text{Sname}, \text{Branch}) \Rightarrow$ Possible non-trivial FDs w.r.t. attributes of rel R are

Every non-trivial FD
need not hold true
in the given relation

$\text{Sid} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$
 $\text{Sid} \rightarrow \text{Branch}$
 $\text{Sname} \rightarrow \text{Sid}$

$\text{Sname} \rightarrow \text{Branch}$
 $\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sid}$
 $\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$

$\text{Sid} \rightarrow \text{Sname}, \text{Branch}$
 $\text{Sname} \rightarrow \text{Sid}, \text{Branch}$
 $\text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sid}, \text{Sname}$

$\text{Sid}, \text{Sname} \rightarrow \text{Branch}$
 $\text{Sid}, \text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sname}$
 $\text{Sname}, \text{Branch} \rightarrow \text{Sid}$



Topic : Semi non-trivial Functional Dependency

FD $X \rightarrow Y$ can be called a semi non-trivial FD

if and only if

(i) $X \not\equiv Y$

and (ii) $X \cap Y \neq \emptyset$

eg. $R(\text{Sid}, \text{Sname}, \text{Branch})$

$\text{Sid}, \text{Sname} \rightarrow \text{Sname}, \text{Branch}$

$\{\text{Sid}, \text{Sname}\} \not\equiv \{\text{Sname}, \text{Branch}\}$

$\{\text{Sid}, \text{Sname}\} \cap \{\text{Sname}, \text{Branch}\} = \{\text{Sname}\} \neq \emptyset$

Both condⁿ are satisfied,
∴ we can call it semi non-trivial FD.

#Q.

Consider the following relational instance

A	B	C
1	1	1
1	1	2
2	1	2
2	2	3
3	3	4

Possible non-trivial FDs w.r.t attributes A, B & C

$A \rightarrow B$ ✗

$A \rightarrow BC$ ✗

$AB \rightarrow C$ ✗

$A \rightarrow C$ ✗

$B \rightarrow AC$ ✗

$AC \rightarrow B$ may hold

$B \rightarrow A$ ✗

$C \rightarrow AB$ ✗

$BC \rightarrow A$ ✗

$B \rightarrow C$ ✗

$C \rightarrow A$ ✗

$C \rightarrow B$ may hold based on given relational instance

Find all non-trivial FDs which may hold true in the above relation based on given relational instance.

Ans. $C \rightarrow B$ & $AC \rightarrow B$

#Q. Write all possible non-trivial FDs with respect to relational schema

$R(A, B, C, D)$

GATE:- FD $X \rightarrow Y$ is called a useful FD
if both X & Y are the non-empty sets
of attributes

and $X \cap Y = \emptyset$

How many useful FDs are possible in a relation
with "4" attributes.

Possible non-trivial FDs over 4 attributes A, B, C & D

$A \rightarrow B$
 $A \rightarrow C$
 $A \rightarrow D$
 $B \rightarrow A$
 $B \rightarrow C$
 $B \rightarrow D$
 $C \rightarrow A$
 $C \rightarrow B$
 $C \rightarrow D$
 $D \rightarrow A$
 $D \rightarrow B$
 $D \rightarrow C$

$A \rightarrow BC$
 $A \rightarrow BD$
 $A \rightarrow CD$
 $B \rightarrow AC$
 $B \rightarrow AD$
 $B \rightarrow CD$
 $C \rightarrow AB$
 $C \rightarrow AD$
 $C \rightarrow BD$
 $D \rightarrow AB$
 $D \rightarrow AC$
 $D \rightarrow BC$

$A \rightarrow BCD$
 $B \rightarrow ACD$
 $C \rightarrow ABD$
 $D \rightarrow ABC$

28 non-trivial FDs
Which contain
exactly one
attribute in LHS.

$AB \rightarrow C$
 $AB \rightarrow D$
 $AC \rightarrow B$
 $AC \rightarrow D$
 $AD \rightarrow B$
 $AD \rightarrow C$
 $BC \rightarrow A$
 $BC \rightarrow D$
 $BD \rightarrow A$
 $BD \rightarrow C$
 $CD \rightarrow A$
 $CD \rightarrow B$

$AB \rightarrow CD$
 $AC \rightarrow BD$
 $AD \rightarrow BC$
 $BC \rightarrow AD$
 $BD \rightarrow AC$
 $CD \rightarrow AB$

18 non-trivial
FDs which
contain
exactly two
attributes in
LHS.

$ABC \rightarrow D$
 $ABD \rightarrow C$
 $ACD \rightarrow B$
 $BCD \rightarrow A$

4 non-trivial FDs
Which contain
exactly three
attributes in LHS.

∴ Total no. of non-trivial FDs Possible = $28 + 18 + 4 = 50$

• Possible non-trivial FDs over 4 attributes A, B, C & D

• Total number of attributes = 4

Case ① When Exactly '1' attribute is present in L.H.S. of $X \longrightarrow Y$

${}^4C_1 * ({}^3C_1 + {}^3C_2 + {}^3C_3) = 4 * (3 + 3 + 1)$
Choose '1' out of '4' in L.H.S. (and) in R.H.S. we can choose '1' or '2' or '3' out of 3
 $= 4 * 7 = 28$

Case ② When Exactly 2 attributes are present in L.H.S. of $X \longrightarrow Y$

${}^4C_2 * ({}^2C_1 + {}^2C_2) = 6 * (2 + 1)$
 $= 6 * 3 = 18$

Case ③ When Exactly 3 attributes are present in L.H.S. of $X \longrightarrow Y$

${}^4C_3 * ({}^1C_1) = 4 * 1 = 4$

∴ Total no. of FDs = $28 + 18 + 4 = 50$

Q: Find the number of non-trivial FDs possible
Over relation $R(A, B, C, D, E)$



Topic : Properties of Functional Dependencies

- ① Reflexivity :- If $X \supseteq Y$, then $X \rightarrow Y$ is called a reflexive FD.
Every reflexive FD always holds true in a relation
- ② Augmentation:- Let functional dependency $X \rightarrow Y$ exist in relation R and 'Z' is some set of attributes over relation R, then $XZ \rightarrow YZ$ will also hold true in relation R
- ③ Transitivity:- Let FDs $X \rightarrow Y$ and $Y \rightarrow Z$ exist in relation R then $X \rightarrow Z$ will also hold true in relation R

These three properties are called Armstrong's Axiom.

④ Decomposition : If $X \rightarrow YZ$ exist in relation R, then $X \rightarrow Y$ as well as $X \rightarrow Z$ will also exist in relation R

If $XY \rightarrow Z$ holds in relation R
then $X \rightarrow Z$ and $Y \rightarrow Z$
need not hold in relation R

We are not allowed to split the
FDs wrt. attributes in L.H.S.

Let, $AB \rightarrow BC$ exists in relation R

$\underbrace{AB \rightarrow BC}_{\text{Semi non-trivial}} \Rightarrow \text{Apply decomposition} \Rightarrow \begin{matrix} AB \rightarrow B \text{ (trivial part)} \\ AB \rightarrow C \text{ (Non-trivial part)} \end{matrix}$

We can always decompose a semi non-trivial
FD into two parts (1) Trivial Part (useless)
& (2) Non-trivial Part (useful)

⑤ Union :- If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $X \rightarrow Z$ exists in relation R ,
then $X \rightarrow YZ$ will also hold true in relation R

⑥ Composition :- If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $P \rightarrow Q$ exists in relation R ,
then $XP \rightarrow YQ$ will also hold true in relation R .

⑦ Pseudo Transitivity :- If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $YW \rightarrow Z$ exists in $rel^h R$,
then $XW \rightarrow Z$ will also hold true in $rel^h R$



Topic : Different types of keys

H.W. Read about :

- ① Candidate Key
- ② Primary Key
- ③ Alternate Key
- ④ Super Key

THANK - YOU